polling is implemented by Node.js interfacing with the operating system.

HTTP module

The Node.js HTTP module provides low-level methods for making HTTP requests and serving HTTP responses. In listing 3.4 a server is created using `http.createServer` and then told to `listen` for incoming request events on port 8080 on the host 127.0.0.1.

3.3.4. Exercises

Use these exercises to build your confidence working with programs that contain functions:

- Add a word-counting function to the file-serving code in listing 3.4 so that the web server responds with the number of attendees to the party, given the following attendees list:

  ```
  'Talos,Gnut,Torg,Ash,Beta,Max,Bender'
  ```

- See what happens when you change the list of attendees in the file being watched from the previous exercise.

This ends the scenic route you took to understanding how central functions work in CoffeeScript. In order to achieve anything of practical value (like serving a website), you have to use callback functions. Functions are important, so you must become proficient at using them. This begins with the idea of higher-order functions.

3.4. Higher-order functions

Remember, *functions are values*. A function can be invoked by another function, supplied as an argument to another function, and be the return value of a function. Using these techniques, functions can be glued together. A function that glues together other functions, composing them, is a *higher-order function*.